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tions of outer space.

The government of Telangana plans to provide land at subsidised rate in strategic locations for setting up ground based satellite tracking stations. These tracking stations will require a plethora of customised high-tech components and parts for operation, which would be an additional niche to fill for the Indian electronic components industry.

Telangana is also setting up a ₹13 billion fund to support startups under its Information and Communicational Tech (ICT) policy, which already provides incentive for setting up electronics design and manufacturing units in the state. With space tech focused applications being specifically encouraged, some companies could start specialising in the components and parts required for it. The required components have to operate in extreme environment encountered in outer space or the deep sea, where extreme variable pressure, lack of gravity, and high radiation levels make regular components fail. This highly specialised design and manufacturing capability can give India a strategic edge and possibly make it a global supplier.

Government of Telangana also plans to support individuals and startups with intellectual property (IP) development and preservation by providing advisory services in filing patents and ensuring legal compliance, both domestically and internationally. Securing their IP is a major concern for companies of all sizes operating in the high-tech space. And if state support can streamline the process, it can help many small players save significant legal consultancy and litigation costs.

The synergising efforts also extend to the insurance, banking, and financial services sectors that, as the policy states, have a historical “disconnect with the SpaceTech ecosystem.” The policy highlights the need for a better understanding in analysing the risk associated with building and operating big-ticket items, such as privately owned and built space launch vehicles and satellites. This will enable insurers to provide appropriately priced solutions for regulatory compliance and general safety norms. There is a close overlap between the insurance and associated claim investigations and certification expertise needed for offering such solutions in India and upskilling workforces.

The policy pegs skill development, training, and facilitating research and innovation as an important fulcrum. Telangana hopes to support R&D partnerships across academia, public sector units, international bodies, and industry with grants, fellowships, and infrastructure. However, if this effort is concentrated in developing key expertise in manufacturing and certification across sectors like composite materials, silicon photolithography processes, and packaging and testing ICs, there would be much quicker and meaningful dividends for the state and country's economy. **EFY**